

found Atari. This was the first game where the concept of creating a machine for a game was started (unlike now where we create games for existing platforms), i.e., the birth of the arcade cabinet. Unfortunately, the game didn't do too well, and was too complicated for its time, the simpler and more popular Pong that released soon after easily eclipsed it.

MORTAL KOMBAT – UNLOCKING ERROR MACROS

Mortal Kombat has seen its fair share of controversy thanks to its depiction of violence and gore. These of course helped its fame catapult even more. Players were obsessed with the game, and of course they were able to get into hidden menus in the game, which is how the existence of the hidden character Reptile was discovered. However, in the hidden menu that showed Reptile, there was another name spotted, right below Reptile. This name was Ermacs. The claims for how he could be unlocked and several



methods to unlock the hidden character started making the rounds soon after the discovery, with even popular gaming magazines pitching in, claiming to have letters sent to them by readers with instructions on unlocking the hidden character. Those of you who play Mortal Kombat now already know that Ermac is an actual character in the game, but he didn't exist at the time. There weren't even plans to make him. Ermacs simply stood for Error macros. The devs added Ermac to the game in Ultimate Mortal Kombat 3, bowing to the hype.

007 GOLDENEYE – BONDS, JAMES BONDS

007 GoldenEye for the Nintendo 64 is one of the most prolific games of its time, and one of the epochs of the FPS genre. While the story followed that of the movie, the game was most remembered for its multiplayer. Up to 4 players could take on each other on several different maps, and there were a bunch of different characters you could play as. This included Bond himself, and a bunch of characters from the GoldenEye movie. The myth was



that one could apparently unlock the past James Bond actor skins in the game, including Roger Moore, Timothy Dalton, and Sean Connery. While definitely a myth, it was almost the truth, because the developers actually wanted to include the previous Bonds' but weren't able to secure their likeness for the game.

SONIC 3 OST FEAT. MICHAEL JACKSON

Around the time Sonic 3 released, there were rumours flying about that Michael Jackson composed some of the music in the game. Some of the music in the game did actually sound like his stuff, so the rumours and myths were not unfounded. The myth continues that Jackson was even going to get end credits for the music, but opted out because he wasn't happy with the end product. The other side of the coin is that Sega wasn't happy with all the negative press he was receiving



at the time and dropped him. Sega still denies Michael Jackson having any involvement with Sonic 3 to this day, however over time it looks like he actually might have contributed to the game's OST, but pulled out because he wasn't happy with the sound performance on the SEGA Genesis console.

POLYBIUS

This is a myth that we've probably never heard of considering the golden age of arcade gaming never happened here. An interesting myth nevertheless, this one is about the arcade game Polybius. Polybius was reportedly available to play only for a month, it supposedly magically appeared overnight in Portland, Oregon, from out of nowhere. For the single month that it was available it had gamers lined up to



play it because it was incredibly addictive. Of course, the rumour doesn't end there, the arcade cabinet was supposedly maintained by men in black suits which led to the rumour that the game was actually the government testing out a new weapon. Those who played the game would suffer from amnesia, insomnia, night terrors and hallucinations. If that wasn't all, once a month was over, the cabinet disappeared the same way it appeared, never to be seen again. None of the myths or rumours have been proven true, and while there are developers who have claimed to have worked on the game, we still don't know for sure. This one is still a bit of a mystery.

And there we have just a few of many gaming myths debunked, or even proved true in some cases. We're sure there are many popular ones we've missed, we simply didn't have any more room for them. However, do let us know what your favourite gaming myths are by writing in to feedback@skoar.in.*